ALEKSANDER PSUREK

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Education

George Mason University Expected May 2027
Ph.D. in Economics (in progress)

George Mason University May 2023
M.A. in Economics

University of Maryland May 2021
M.S. in Quantitative Finance

University of Maryland May 2020
B.S. in Finance; B.S. in Information Systems; B.S. in Economics

Research and Teaching Fields

Primary: Political Economy; Applied Econometrics; Experimental Economics.
Secondary: Law and Economics; Computational Economics; Finance.

Job Market Paper

Threats, Stakes, and Backlash: Evidence from the European Union on Economic Coercion within Organizations

How can a voluntary union enforce its institutional rules when its members begin to drift from the agreed institutional paradigm? Financial transfers may serve as a tool of institutional alignment, but threatening or withdrawing these transfers as a tool of economic coercion may risk creating a backlash and lead to membership quits. I examine this tension empirically in the context of the European Union's rule-of-law dispute with Poland. This multi-year dispute began with formal public condemnation and escalated by its end to genuine economic coercion. I exploit the differential within-country exposure to historical European Union (EU) funded projects and the staged nature of this legal dispute to measure the local effectiveness of withdrawing financial transfers as a tool of political persuasion. Combining municipal election returns with historical local exposure to EU funding, I compare electoral changes across 2,475 municipalities in the 2015, 2019, and 2023 Polish parliamentary elections. I find that between 2019 and 2023, as the condemnation turned into a genuine sanction, more-exposed municipalities experienced an additional decline of approximately 0.48 percentage points in incumbent support and 0.58 points in support for the broader anti-European-integrationist bloc. These local effects can be interpreted as the causal effect of additional financial sanction exposure under a conditional parallel trends assumption and a constant signal response. I find no clear exposure-related backlash during the condemnation phase of the dispute or a persistent backlash in subsequent European Parliament voting. The findings suggest that financial interdependence can stabilize voluntary unions through electoral pressure acting upon noncompliant governments that challenge institutional rules, without necessarily generating a lasting backlash against integration.

Published Paper

The Hole in the Doughnut: Formalizing and Testing a Key Model of Degrowth

with Ashruta Acharya and Vincent Geloso

Contemporary Economic Policy 44(3): 549–575 (2026). doi:10.1111/coep.70031

We investigate the empirical relationship between market-oriented institutions and policy objectives outside of economic growth, including balanced outcomes in the style of Doughnut Economics, an increasingly influential policy paradigm.

Working Papers

Regulatory Stringency and Endogeneity

with Vincent Geloso and Alex Tabarrok

We study the effect of regulation on end-outcomes with variation across U.S. states and industries, using an instrumental variable design.

Action Bias or Illusion of Control?

with Kevin McCabe and Johanna Mollerstrom

We investigate the long-standing psychological puzzle of the illusion of control and contrasting it with an alternative explanation in the action bias, providing evidence from laboratory experiments.

Decentralized Emergence of Market Organization

with Kevin McCabe

Using agent-based simulations, we study the emergence of markets over a spatial grid and measuring the effects of market interventions on the structure of markets

Determinants of Automated Market-Making Efficiency and Microstructure

with Sarah Dean (Sylverman), Kevin McCabe, and Nalin Bhat

We study the price-efficiency, volatility, and distributional impacts of automated market-making institutions, varying institutional details, demand-supply relationships, and market structure

The Revolving Door: Effects of Administrative Service on Lobbying Efforts

with Thomas Stratmann

We study the effects of service in U.S. presidential administrations on lobbying revenues and spending, linking federal appointment records to lobbying disclosures using a difference-in-differences design.

A Model of Reputation-Motivated Vote Trading and Its Implications

with Nicholas Brown and Cesar Martinelli

We study how reputation-driven vote trading and pork-barrel spending affect legislative passage and welfare, using a formal model and computational simulations that vary legislative size and political polarization.

An Economic Evaluation of the Drug Epidemic in the United States

with Kevin Ciocco

We study economic explanations for the rise in U.S. drug overdose deaths, drawing upon geographic and temporal variation in income, employment, and healthcare affordability.

Works in Progress

Are Minimum Wages Mobility Barriers?

with Vincent Geloso

We investigate the effects of minimum wages on intragenerational mobility, drawing upon intertemporal and cross-provincial variation within Canada and income-percentile cohort-level economic mobility data.

Borrowed Confidence: Does Generative AI Distort Decision-Makers' Beliefs About What They Can Do Without It?

with Abdul Ali

We study the effects of AI recommendation systems on decision makers' assessments of their abilities in a forecasting and data integration task through a lab experiment. Selected for 2026-2027 NASPO SCM Behavioral Lab Seed Grant ($2,000 USD; Arizona State University).

Teaching Experience

George Mason University Fairfax, VA

Co-instructor

- Managerial Economics (undergraduate): fall 2024, 2025, 2026.
- Causal Inference Microeconometrics (graduate): fall 2024.
- Experimental Economics I (graduate): spring 2024, 2025, 2026.
- Computational Economics (graduate): fall 2024, 2025, 2026.

Responsibilities across courses included lecture development and delivery, exam writing, project mentoring, and individual feedback on research papers.

CSN Summer Research Workshop Summers 2020, 2021

Research Head and Lecturer | Undergraduate | Online

University of Maryland, Smith School of Business Aug 2020–May 2021

Teaching Assistant | Online master's program

Fellowships and Awards

ICES Ph.D. Fellowship, George Mason University 2021–2027

Bradley Fellowship in Economics, GMU Public Choice 2023, 2025, 2026

APEE Young Scholar Award 2024, 2026

Presentations

Economic Science Association, North America: 2023, 2026; Europe: 2025. Southern Economic Association: 2024, 2025. Association of Private Enterprise Education: 2024, 2026. Euro-African Conference on Finance and Economics / Mediterranean Workshop in Economic Theory: 2024.

Internal seminars: GMU–ICES Brown Bag Series (four presentations); Geloso–Naumenko Seminar Series (three presentations).

Service and Engagement

Peer reviewer: Journal of International Financial Markets, Institutions & Money.

Replicator: Institute for Replication, Brno Replication Games (2025); Tampa Replication Games (2025).

Association member: Economic Science Association; American Economic Association; Econometric Society; National Association for Business Economics.

References

Thomas Stratmann — Distinguished University Professor; Professor of Economics
Department of Economics and ICES, George Mason University
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Kevin McCabe — Professor of Economics and Law
Department of Economics and ICES, George Mason University
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Alex Tabarrok — Professor of Economics; Bartley J. Madden Chair in Economics
Department of Economics and Mercatus Center, George Mason University
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Vincent Geloso — Associate Professor of Economics
Department of Economics, George Mason University; CIRANO
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Johanna Mollerstrom — Professor of Economics
Department of Economics and ICES, George Mason University
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Cesar Martinelli — Professor of Economics
Department of Economics and ICES, George Mason University
cmarti33@gmu.edu | +1 703-993-4853

Research and Professional Experience

George Mason University Jun 2018–present
Research Assistant | Arlington, VA

Federal Agricultural Mortgage Corporation (Farmer Mac) May–Aug 2025
Finance and Economics Intern | Washington, DC

University of Maryland, Smith School of Business Aug 2020–May 2021
Research Assistant | College Park, MD

Global Equities Fund, University of Maryland 2020–2021
Investment Analyst

International Monetary Fund May–Aug 2020
Research Consultant | Washington, DC

Polish Embassy in Washington, DC Dec 2018–Jan 2019
Politics and Economics Intern

University of Maryland, BSOS Economics Sep 2017–Jan 2019
Research Assistant | College Park, MD

National Institute of Standards and Technology 2018
Market Consultant

Skills and Training

Summer School in Meta-Analysis and Open Science, 2025.
CITI Human Subjects Research Certification, 2018.
Tools: Git/GitHub, Enterprise Linux, AWS, Qualtrics, Claude, Codex.
Programming: Python, Stata, R, SQL, JavaScript, HTML/CSS.
Languages: English and Polish (native); French (intermediate).